AIR UNIVERSITY • KARACHI CAMPUS • PAKISTAN

VIDEO PRODUCTION SCRIPT — STUDENT SHORT-FORM REEL

PEHLA DIN AT AU KARACHI

A prospective student's first-day POV • 75 seconds • Instagram Reel / YouTube Short

LOGLINE: *A hesitant F.Sc. leaver walks through Air University Karachi Campus on her imagined first day — and discovers a home where her ambition, her friends, and her future all meet.*

1. Production Specifications

Title: Pehla Din at AU Karachi
Format: Short-form vertical video (9:16 native, 16:9 master) — screenplay
Duration: 75 seconds (1:15)
Audience: Prospective students — F.Sc. / A-Level leavers and parents in Sindh, Pakistan
Tone: Energetic, youthful, cinematic-vlog POV, Gen-Z rhythm
Language: Roman Urdu + English mix (spoken VO + on-screen text in English)
Deliverable: 1× master MP4 (H.264, 4K UHD), 1× 9:16 vertical cut for Reels/TikTok
Aspect Ratio: 9:16 (primary) / 16:9 (secondary)
Frame Rate: 25 fps (PAL, Pakistan broadcast standard)
Music: Upbeat lo-fi hip-hop bed, 95 BPM, with cinematic riser at 0:55
CTA: Admissions Open — Apply at au.edu.pk / Karachi Campus

2. Cast & Talent

ZARA — Protagonist / Narrator

Role: Prospective first-year student, 18, pre-admission. POV host.

Description: Bright, observant, slightly nervous F.Sc. pre-engineering graduate from a Karachi college. Wears a navy dupatta over a white kameez and jeans — modest but modern.

Wardrobe: Navy dupatta, white cotton kameez, blue jeans, white sneakers, tote bag with notebook.

ALI — Friend / Current Student

Role: Second-year BS Computer Science student. Zara's school friend who gives her the tour.

Description: Confident, warm, talkative. Knows the campus like the back of his hand. Wears the AU Karachi hoodie.

Wardrobe: Air University navy hoodie, gray chinos, white sneakers, lanyard with student ID.

CAFETERIA UNCLE (background)

Role: Canteen vendor. No dialogue, warm presence.

Description: Older gentleman who runs the chai counter. Smiles at Zara.

Wardrobe: White apron, green kurta underneath, prayer cap.

LIBRARIAN (background)

Role: Front-desk librarian. Brief nod to Zara.

Description: Mid-40s, professional. Manages the issue counter.

Wardrobe: Charcoal shalwar kameez, glasses on a lanyard.

3. Locations & Set Notes

EXT. AIR UNIVERSITY KARACHI — MAIN GATE

Description: AU Karachi main entrance on Shahrah-e-Faisal side. Signage wall, blue-and-white PAF emblem. Flagpole. Security booth.

Shooting Window: 07:30–08:00 (soft morning light, low crowd)

Permissions: Campus security + Registrar's office sign-off (verbal OK on shoot day).

INT. CENTRAL LIBRARY — GROUND FLOOR

Description: Open reading hall, rows of desks, issue counter, glass-walled silent study pod. Natural light from floor-to-ceiling windows on east wall.

Shooting Window: 09:00–10:00 (post-opening, low occupancy)

Permissions: Chief Librarian's written permission; no filming of computer screens or student faces without consent.

INT. LECTURE HALL — BLOCK C

Description: Tiered lecture theatre, ~80 seats, projector screen, whiteboard, instructor console. A first-year Calculus class in progress (background).

Shooting Window: 11:00–11:30 (after class ends, with two willing extras)

Permissions: Block C coordinator consent; extras sign a brief on-camera release.

INT. STUDENT CAFETERIA

Description: Indoor canteen, ~30 seats, chai counter, snack racks, shared tables. Hanging Edison-bulb lighting.

Shooting Window: 12:30–13:15 (peak lunch energy)

Permissions: Cafeteria manager verbal OK; minor extras blurred or signed off.

EXT. SPORTS COURT — BACK LAWN

Description: Open basketball half-court + paved walkway beside sports field. Afternoon golden light. PAF aero squadron banner visible in background.

Shooting Window: 16:00–16:30 (golden hour, post-class play

Permissions: Sports Office verbal OK; players in frame sign release.

4. Props, Wardrobe & Equipment

Wardrobe & Styling

- Navy dupatta for Zara (institutional color match)
- Air University Karachi navy hoodie for Ali (sample from merch desk)
- Tote bag with notebook peeking out — non-branded, neutral canvas
- Lanyard with white student ID card (blank face) for Ali
- Cafeteria uncle's white apron + prayer cap

Hand Props & Set Dressing

- AU Karachi printed prospectus (cover visible) — Zara carries it throughout
- Cup of chai on cafeteria table (steaming, fresh)
- Open Calculus textbook on lecture-hall desk (Stewart, 8th ed.)
- Library desktop monitor showing catalogue homepage (admin-approved)
- Basketball — worn Spalding TF-250 (provided by sports office)
- Phone in Zara's hand with AU admissions page on screen (screen capture pre-loaded)

Camera & Grip

- Primary: Sony FX30 or equivalent APS-C cinema camera (4K 25p)
- Secondary: iPhone 15 Pro for 9:16 POV shots (Cinematic mode)
- Lens: Sigma 18-50mm f/2.8 DC DN (standard zoom) on FX30
- Lens: 16mm f/2.8 prime for low-light library + cafeteria interior
- Gimbal: DJI RS3 Mini for tracking shots
- Tripod: Manfrotto 504X with mid-level spreader for static wides
- Slider: 60 cm motorized slider for push-in on library establishing shot
- ND filters (4-stop variable) for exterior daylight control
- C-Stand + 1.2m bounce (5-in-1 reflector) for window fill in library

Audio & Lighting

- Wireless lavalier kit: 2× Rode Wireless GO II (one for Zara, one for Ali)
- Shotgun mic: Rode NTG5 on boom pole for ambient / cafeteria buzz
- Portable recorder: Zoom H5 (for ambience + music sync later)
- Key light: Aputure 100X bi-color with softbox (cafeteria close-ups)
- Practical: existing Edison bulbs in cafeteria (kept on for warmth)
- Reflectors: gold/silver 5-in-1 for golden-hour fill on sports court

5. Detailed Shot List

All shots 4K UHD 3840×2160, 16:9 frame, color graded to warm institutional palette (navy + amber). Total runtime target shown in specs.

Shot #	Time	INT/EXT Location	Camera / Move	Lens	Lighting	Audio Cue	Action Description
1.1	0:00–0:05 (5s)	EXT. Main Gate — Morning	Static wide, locked-off on tripod	16mm f/2.8	Natural morning, soft + cool	VO narration begins; ambient street hum + birds fade in	Locked-off wide of AU Karachi main gate signage wall. PAF emblem visible. Zara enters frame from left, walking toward camera, prospectus in hand. Holds at gate, looks up at sign. Title card burns in over her face: PEHLA DIN AT AU KARACHI.
1.2	0:05–0:08 (3s)	EXT. Main Gate — Morning	Low-angle tracking push-in (gimbal)	24mm f/2.8	Backlit, sun behind signage	VO continues; subtle riser begins	Gimbal push-in from Zara's POV — from chest height up to the AU signage above the gate. Sign fills frame at 0:08. Whip-pan transition out.
1.3	0:08–0:12 (4s)	EXT. Campus Walkway	Steady handheld tracking (Zara's shoulder level)	24mm f/2.8	Open shade, even daylight	VO + ambient chatter, footsteps on tile	Tracking beside Zara as she walks the main promenade. Ali enters from frame right, taps her shoulder. They greet. Quick handheld energy. Zara's prospectus visibly in her left hand.

Shot #	Time	INT/EXT Location	Camera / Move	Lens	Lighting	Audio Cue	Action Description
1.4	0:12–0:15 (3s)	INT. Library Ground Floor	Slider push-in, slow (60cm in 3s)	16mm f/2.8	East window daylight + bounce fill	VO + soft library hum, page turns	Static push-in on the library reading hall. Empty desks foregrounded, librarian at counter midground. Zara and Ali walk through back of frame left-to-right. Lens flare from east window at 0:14.
1.5	0:15–0:19 (4s)	INT. Library Silent Study Pod	Handheld over-shoulder, Zara's POV	24mm f/2.8	Cool window + practical lamp	VO + muffled keyboard clicks	Zara's POV looking through the glass wall of the silent study pod. A senior student looks up, nods, returns to a laptop. Zara's reflection in the glass — moment of quiet wonder.
1.6	0:19–0:24 (5s)	INT. Lecture Hall Block C	Wide static, locked-off	16mm f/2.8	Ceiling fluorescent, daylight balanced	VO + faint chalk on board, distant projector fan	Locked wide of empty lecture theatre post-class. Zara walks down the central aisle, hand trailing seat backs. Ali points to the projector screen. Zara sits in the third row, opens notebook.
1.7	0:24–0:27 (3s)	INT. Lecture Hall — Same	Close-up, handheld	35mm f/2.8	Window key from stage side	VO key line; subtle cello note	Insert close-up: Zara's hand opens notebook. First page. Writes her name + "BS Computer Science, Year 1". Pen scratches. Lens focuses on her written name.
1.8	0:27–0:32 (5s)	INT. Cafeteria	Steady gimbal dolly, Z-frame	24mm f/2.8	Edison practicals + soft key (Aputure 100X)	VO + cafeteria buzz, clinking cups	Gimbal dolly-in on Zara and Ali at a window-side table. Cup of chai steams between them. Ali gestures broadly. Zara laughs, looks around at the busy canteen. Cafeteria Uncle waves from the counter in background.
1.9	0:32–0:35 (3s)	INT. Cafeteria Counter	Tight insert, static	50mm f/1.8	Counter practicals	VO; chai pour SFX	Insert: Cafeteria Uncle pours chai from a steel teapot into a white cup. Steam rises. He smiles. Lens focuses on the pour, then racks to his face.

Shot #	Time	INT/EXT Location	Camera / Move	Lens	Lighting	Audio Cue	Action Description
1.10	0:35–0:40 (5s)	EXT. Sports Court Back Lawn	Handheld tracking, low angle	24mm f/2.8	Golden hour, 16:00 sun	VO emotional pivot; music swells	Tracking beside Zara as she walks the paved walkway past the basketball half-court. Two students shoot hoops in background. PAF aero squadron banner drifts in the breeze. Zara pauses, looks up at the sky.
1.11	0:40–0:45 (5s)	EXT. Sports Court	Low-angle wide, gimbal orbit	16mm f/2.8	Backlit golden hour	Music swells; VO final beat	Gimbal orbits Zara (half-circle, 3 sec), backlit by the setting sun. She turns to face the camera — first time she directly addresses the lens. Confident smile. Holds look.
1.12	0:45–0:50 (5s)	EXT. Campus Walkway	Tracking pull-back (gimbal)	24mm f/2.8	Warm afternoon	VO CTA; music build	Gimbal pull-back as Zara walks toward camera, then past it. She looks content, prospectus now tucked under her arm like a kept promise. Ali jogs up behind her, throws arm over shoulder. They walk into the sunset together.
1.13	0:50–0:55 (5s)	EXT. Main Gate — Late Afternoon	Static wide, locked-off	16mm f/2.8	Golden hour, warm	Music climax; VO final line	Locked wide of the main gate again — same frame as Shot 1.1. Zara and Ali exit through it. Zara pauses at the gate, looks back at the campus once. Smiles. Walks out of frame.
1.14	0:55–1:00 (5s)	Insert / Title Card	Static, simple graphics card	—	—	Music sting; VO ends	End-card animation: Air University Karachi logo top, "ADMISSIONS OPEN — FALL INTAKE" middle, au.edu.pk URL + QR code bottom. Navy background, amber accent line. Subtle pulse animation.

Shot #	Time	INT/EXT Location	Camera / Move	Lens	Lighting	Audio Cue	Action Description
1.15	1:00–1:15 (15s)	Insert / B-Roll Reel	Fast montage cuts (avg 1.2s each)	Mixed	Mixed	Music outro; loopable for IG	B-roll montage reel — 12 quick cuts from the day's best shots cut to music: gate push-in, library flare, lecture hall wide, chai pour, sports court orbit, golden-hour smile, gate exit, end-card hold. Cuts on beat. Designed to loop seamlessly back to Shot 1.1 for IG Reel repeat.

6. Full Screenplay

FADE IN:

MUSIC IN: upbeat lo-fi hip-hop bed, 95 BPM. Soft synth pad. Vinyl crackle.

EXT. AIR UNIVERSITY KARACHI — MAIN GATE — MORNING

A bright Karachi morning. Sun glints off the AU Karachi signage wall. The PAF emblem — eagle, crescent, star — sits crisp above the gate. ZARA (18, navy dupatta, prospectus in hand) enters frame from the left, walking slowly. She stops at the gate. Looks up at the sign. Catches her breath.

ZARA (V.O.)
Pehla din. Har student ka pehla din ek jaisa hota hai… thora darr, thora khawab, aur bohat sae sawaal.

She takes one step forward. The gate is suddenly bigger than she expected.

ZARA (V.O.)
But when you walk through the gate of Air University Karachi… you don't walk in alone.

RISER BUILDS — subtle cello swell under VO.

EXT. CAMPUS WALKWAY — MOMENTS LATER

Zara walks the main promenade, looking around at the blocks. ALI (19, AU hoodie, lanyard) jogs up from behind and taps her shoulder.

ALI
Oye Zara! Late nahi, bas beginner ka hesitation hai. Chal, pehle library dikhata hoon.

ZARA
(smiling, relieved)
Bohat bhai ho yaar. Lead the way.

CUT TO:

INT. CENTRAL LIBRARY — GROUND FLOOR — CONTINUOUS

Slider push-in. The reading hall opens up — rows of desks, east-window daylight pooling on the floor, librarian at the counter. Zara and Ali enter from the back. They pause at the silent study pod.

ZARA (V.O.)
Yeh hai hamari central library. Silent study pods, digital archives, aur wo corner wali seat — har final-week student ki favourite.

Zara's POV through the glass pod wall. A senior student looks up, nods once, returns to his laptop. Zara's own reflection floats over his screen — quiet wonder on her face.

CUT TO:

INT. LECTURE HALL — BLOCK C — LATE MORNING

Empty tiered theatre post-class. Zara walks down the central aisle, hand trailing the seat backs. Ali points to the projector screen.

ALI
Yeh tumhara first-year Calculus ka hall hai. Sir Rehmat ki section kaafi mashhoor hai — kahin late mat hona.

Zara sits in the third row. Opens her notebook. Writes, in neat block letters: ZARA — BS COMPUTER SCIENCE, YEAR 1. Camera holds on her written name for one extra beat.

ZARA (V.O.)
Pehla din. Pehla naam. Pehli seat. Yehi se sab shuru hota hai.

♫ MUSIC shifts — warmer, slight melodic line enters.

CUT TO:

INT. STUDENT CAFETERIA — LUNCH HOUR

Canteen buzzing. Zara and Ali at a window-side table. Cup of chai steams between them. Ali gestures broadly about something. Zara laughs — first real laugh of the day. CAFETERIA UNCLE waves from the counter.

ZARA (V.O.)
Aur yeh humari canteen — jahan har bad news, har good news, aur har 'kal ka assignment' pehle chai se deal hoti hai.

Insert: Uncle pours chai from a steel teapot into a white cup. Steam rises. He smiles — the kind of smile that says: welcome back, beta.

CUT TO:

EXT. SPORTS COURT — BACK LAWN — GOLDEN HOUR

Late afternoon, golden light. Zara walks the paved walkway past the basketball half-court. Two students shoot hoops in the background. The PAF aero squadron banner drifts in the breeze. Zara stops. Looks up at the sky.

ZARA (V.O.)
Aur jab shaam ho jaati hai, campus ek aur rang mein dhal jaata hai — thora sport, thora dost, thora shor.

Gimbal orbits Zara — half-circle. Backlit. She turns and directly faces the camera for the first time. Confident smile. Holds the look.

ZARA (V.O.)
Toh haan — Air University Karachi. Yeh sirf ek campus nahi. Yeh wo jagah hai jahan aap apni pehli tasveer khud khinchte ho.

MUSIC SWELLS — full beat returns, melodic hook peaks.

EXT. MAIN GATE — LATE AFTERNOON

Same locked wide as Shot 1.1 — but warmer light now. Zara and Ali exit through the gate. Zara pauses at the threshold, looks back at the campus once. Smiles. Walks out of frame.

ZARA (V.O.)
Admissions open hain. Aap ka pehla din, yaad rahega. Visit kar lijiye — au.edu.pk / Karachi Campus.

MUSIC STING — final hit, then tail out.

END CARD — GRAPHIC

Navy background. Air University Karachi logo top. Amber accent rule. "ADMISSIONS OPEN — FALL INTAKE" center. URL + QR code bottom. Subtle pulse on the amber rule.

FADE OUT.

FADE OUT. THE END.

7. Music & Sound Design Notes

- Primary bed: royalty-free upbeat lo-fi hip-hop, ~95 BPM, soft synth pad, vinyl crackle. Source: Pixabay Music or Artlist (license held by Media Cell).
- Riser at 0:55: 4-second cello swell under Zara's emotional pivot on sports court.
- Music sting at 1:00: clean single hit (kick + low synth) to land the end-card.
- Tail (1:00–1:15): music continues under the B-roll montage, designed to loop seamlessly back to Shot 1.1 for IG Reel auto-repeat.
- SFX design: soft footstep Foley for interior tracking shots, library page turns, chai pour + ceramic clink, distant basketball bounce on sports court, ambient student chatter (loopable room tone).

- VO recording: Zara's VO must be recorded in a treated booth, not on-set. Aim for -12 LUFS final mix, -16 LUFS for IG/TikTok export. Stereo for YouTube master, mono-compatible for vertical cut.

8. Production Notes

- **Director:** Student Media Cell Director (assign from senior batch, 1 director + 1 AD)
- **Producer:** AU Karachi Media & Admissions Office (faculty mentor: 1)
- **Director of Photography:** 1 senior student cinematographer with FX30 experience
- **Sound Recordist:** 1 student boom op with Zoom H5 + Rode Wireless GO II kit
- **Grip / Gaffer:** 1 student assistant for gimbal, slider, reflector handling
- **Production Designer:** 1 student stylist — wardrobe continuity + prospectus + chai setup
- **Cast Coordinator:** 1 student PA — extras release forms + scheduling
- **Total Crew Size:** 6 students + 1 faculty mentor
- **Shoot Days:** 1 primary shoot day (Friday, 07:30–17:00 to capture morning + golden hour)
- **Backup Day:** 1 reserve day for weather / actor availability (Saturday)
- **Locations Walkthrough:** Conducted 2 days before shoot — confirm light + permissions
- **Insurance:** University student media insurance covers on-campus equipment only
- **Permits:** Verbal / written permission from: Registrar, Chief Librarian, Block C Coordinator, Cafeteria Manager, Sports Office
- **Data Wrangling:** Daily backup to 2× SSDs (1 master, 1 mirror); LTO archive optional
- **Post-Production:** DaVinci Resolve (free) for edit + grade; Adobe Audition for VO + mix; Premiere or CapCut for vertical IG export
- **Delivery Format:** 1× 4K UHD MP4 H.264 25p master; 1× 1080p 9:16 MP4 for IG Reels/TikTok; 1× 1080p 16:9 MP4 for YouTube Short
- **Captioning:** English SRT burned-in for IG (Roman Urdu dialogue lines kept as-is); optional Urdu script SRT for accessibility
- **Distribution:** Instagram Reels (primary), TikTok, YouTube Shorts, AU Karachi website hero, paid Meta Ads targeting F.Sc. leavers in Sindh